

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction
for the administration of Azithromycin for the treatment of Traveller's Diarrhoea

Summary of NICE CKS Guidelines for Traveller's Diarrhoea

Overview

- **Traveller's diarrhoea** is defined as **≥ 3 loose or watery stools in 24 hours**, often accompanied by **abdominal cramps, nausea, or vomiting**, occurring during or shortly after travel, typically to low- and middle-income countries.
- Most cases are **mild, self-limiting**, and resolve within **3–5 days**.
- Common pathogens: **Enterotoxigenic *E. coli* (ETEC), Campylobacter, Shigella, Salmonella**, and viruses.

Risk Factors

- Travel to high-risk areas (e.g. South Asia, Sub-Saharan Africa, Latin America)
- Poor sanitation and hygiene
- Eating street food or raw/undercooked food
- Young age, immunocompromise, PPI use

Prevention Advice

Food and Water Hygiene

- Drink **bottled or purified water**
- Avoid **ice, salads, unpeeled fruit, undercooked meat/seafood**
- Wash hands regularly, especially before eating

Prophylactic Antibiotics

- **Not routinely recommended** due to resistance risk
- May be considered for:
 - High-risk travellers (e.g. immunocompromised)
 - Short-term, high-risk exposure (e.g. disaster relief workers)

Self-Treatment Advice

Mild to Moderate Diarrhoea

- **Oral rehydration** (key priority)
- **Anti-motility agents** (e.g. **loperamide** 4 mg initially, then 2 mg after each loose stool, max 16 mg/day)
- **Loperamide** not for:
 - Children <12
 - Blood in stool
 - Fever

Short-course Antibiotics (if moderate/severe symptoms or essential travel plans disrupted):

- **Azithromycin 500 mg once daily for 1–3 days** (preferred in most areas)
- **Ciprofloxacin 500 mg BD for 1–3 days** (not recommended in SE Asia due to resistance)
- Only provide for **self-start** in **pre-travel consultation** if appropriate

When to Seek Medical Help

- **Fever, bloody diarrhoea, or severe abdominal pain**
- **Persistent vomiting or inability to stay hydrated**
- Diarrhoea lasting **>14 days**
- In **infants, elderly, or immunocompromised** patients

Post-Travel Considerations

- If diarrhoea persists after return:
 - Investigate for **giardiasis, amoebiasis, chronic bacterial infection, or IBS post-infection**
 - Send stool samples if symptoms persist **>7–10 days**

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Azithromycin

for the treatment of

Traveller's Diarrhoea

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC ● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. ● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines ● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication ● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer ● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal ● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products ● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Azithromycin is indicated for the treatment of moderate to severe traveller's diarrhoea, particularly when caused by likely bacterial pathogens and where fluoroquinolone resistance is a concern.
Inclusion criteria	- Adults aged 18 years and over. - Recent or planned travel to high-risk regions for traveller's diarrhoea (e.g., South Asia, Africa). - No known contraindications to macrolide antibiotics. - Informed consent obtained and patient understands when and how to self-treat. - Suitable for self-start treatment during travel if symptoms develop.
Exclusion criteria	- Known allergy to azithromycin or other macrolide antibiotics. - Severe liver disease or significant hepatic dysfunction. - Concomitant medications known to prolong the QT interval. - Bloody diarrhoea, high fever, or signs of systemic illness. - Symptoms lasting more than 72 hours without improvement.
Cautions	- Take tablets with food to reduce GI upset. - Advise patient to maintain hydration and recognise signs of severe illness. - Counsel on seeking local medical attention if symptoms worsen or persist. - Stop treatment if hypersensitivity or serious side effects occur.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Azithromycin
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store below 25°C in original packaging.
Route/method of administration	Oral administration, preferably with food.
Dose and frequency	500 mg once daily for 1 to 3 days, depending on clinical severity.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	One to three 500 mg tablets depending on symptom severity
Maximum or minimum treatment period	Maximum treatment course is 3 days.
Adverse effects	Nausea, abdominal pain, diarrhoea, headache. Rare: hepatotoxicity, allergic reactions, QT prolongation. Refer to SmPC for full details.

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and advise the traveller to consult a healthcare professional if symptoms worsen.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: ● that valid informed consent was given ● name of individual, address, date of birth and GP ● name of healthcare practitioner ● name and brand of medication ● date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied ● advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment ● details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: ● Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years ● Children aged under 18 years -keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with the medication.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	To seek medical advice if symptoms worsen rapidly or significantly, do not improve in 3–4 weeks, or they become systemically very unwell.

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines [BNF \(British National Formulary\) | NICE](#)
- Summary of Product Characteristics for drug

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates

Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date		Expiry date	
13/07/26		31/7/27	

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or vaccine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		13/07/26
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		25/8/2025

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	25 th June 2025
002	Reviewed and authorised for the GRH platform; signed by Medical Director	13th July 2026

